

Four ways to order the same shots

Bar width is duration. Black is the Sun, grey the Ocean, pale the Island; hatched is a shot that does not exist yet. The question these four answer is whether Movement II's back half should fold into Movement III's front half.

A • Linear — three movements in order 0 new anchors



Nothing to build; chains run forward in strict order and the source's own sequence is preserved exactly. **But** it peaks at the vortex at 2:50 and then runs two minutes of falling action, and Oriane dies at 3:18 with two strangers arriving cold.

B • Prologue splice — the beach lands before she does 1 new anchor



Recommended. Splits S15 and moves the first half early, so the brothers are established before Oriane dies — the biggest structural complaint against the current cut, gone for one generation. F23 already carries the streak's reflection, so the only new frame is a clean Nacre Beach dawn with no streak in it. Risk: a quiet beach beat now sits immediately before the film's biggest moment.

C • Alternating — II's back half into III's front half about 3 anchors



Two clocks through the middle, and the scale jump into S13 gets bigger, not smaller. **But** alternation reads as simultaneity and the source explicitly denies it — and it strands three seams: F22/F23 no longer adjoin, S16 has to start off the closing vortex eye, and the green streak needs a new place to land.

D • Full causal interlace about 60 anchors



Argued properly and lost five criteria to three. It needs about 40 generations at a 7-second mean, asks the audience to infer a causal link the text denies, and ends on a resolution rather than a revelation — closing off the novel it exists to introduce.

Why B is cheap and C is not. The full interlace lost on source fidelity and on one-viewing legibility, and both losses come from the same thing: alternation reads as simultaneity, and the source opens the second story “the next day”. A single establishing beat placed early is not alternation. It buys the emotional continuity without asking anyone to infer a causal link the source denies.